



Mindoro State University
Victoria, Oriental Mindoro 5205 Philippines



COLLEGE OF COMPUTER STUDIES



BAGONG PILIPINAS

HIST 111: Readings in the Philippine History

CHAPTER 4:

Identification of Historical Importance of the Text

Submitted by:

REPORTER

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Submitted to:

MA'AM HILA PURA

Submitted on:

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CHAPTER 4: Historical Significance

1. Introduction: What is Historical Significance

Historical significance is the process used to determine which events, people, and developments are important in history.

Not all events are remembered. Historians choose what is important based on different criteria.

2. Criteria in Assessing Historical Significance

a. Relevance

- Important during the time it happened
- Still affects present society

b. Resonance

- Impact on people's lives
- Can be connected across time

c. Remarkable

- Was it noticed or discussed?
- Was it considered important?

d. Remembered

- Part of collective memory
- Celebrated or commemorated

e. Revealing

- Helps understand other aspects of history

3. Measuring Impact of Events

- Resulting in Change

- Did it influence the future?

- Durability

- How long did the effects last?

- Quantity

- How many people were affected?

- Profundity

- How deeply were people affected?



4. Rating an Event's Significance

- Rating Meaning

1-Not significant

2-Slightly significant

3-Moderately significant

4-Very significant

5-Highly significant

5. Levels of Historical Significance

- Not significant
- Individually significant
- Regionally significant
- Nationally significant
- Globally significant

6. Issues in Assessing Historical Significance

- Influenced by modern beliefs and values
- History is often written by the victors
- Significance varies depending on perspective

QUIZ TIME!!!

I. IDENTIFICATION (10 Points)

_____ The process of determining importance in history

_____ Criterion that checks present-day importance

_____ Measures how many people are affected

_____ Measures depth of impact

_____ Measures how long effects last

_____ When an event is remembered or commemorated

_____ When an event helps explain other historical events

_____ When an event is widely noticed

_____ When history depends on viewpoint

_____ Level where the whole world is affected



II. MULTIPLE CHOICE (10 Points)

___ 1. What is historical significance?

- a) Memorizing history
- b) Evaluating importance of events
- c) Writing essays
- d) Studying only famous people

___ 2. Which measures how many people were affected?

- a) Durability
- b) Quantity
- c) Profundity
- d) Resonance

___ 3. Which measures how long effects lasted?

- a) Relevance
- b) Quantity
- c) Durability
- d) Remarkable

___ 4. Which criterion asks if it still affects us today?

- a) Relevance
- b) Remembered
- c) Revealing
- d) Resonance

___ 5. Which refers to depth of impact?

- a) Quantity
- b) Profundity
- c) Durability
- d) Relevance

___ 6. Which is NOT a level of significance?

- a) National



b) Global

c) Personal

d) Regional

___ 7. Why is history subjective?

a) Because of facts

b) Because of perspective

c) Because of time

d) Because of events

___ 8. Which refers to being widely noticed?

a) Remarkable

b) Revealing

c) Resonance

d) Durability

___ 9. Which refers to shared memory?

a) Remembered

b) Relevant

c) Revealing

d) Remarkable

___ 10. Which refers to connection across time?

a) Relevance

b) Resonance

c) Quantity

d) Durability

___ 11. Which focuses on present-day importance?

a) Relevance

b) Quantity

c) Durability

d) Profundity

___ 12. Which level affects only a specific person?



- a) National
- b) Individual
- c) Global
- d) Regional

___ 13. Which measures how deeply people were affected?

- a) Quantity
- b) Durability
- c) Profundity
- d) Relevance

___ 14. Which is part of collective memory?

- a) Remembered
- b) Relevant
- c) Resonance
- d) Remarkable

___ 15. Which criterion asks if people noticed the event?

- a) Remarkable
- b) Revealing
- c) Relevance
- d) Durability

___ 16. Which refers to long-lasting effects?

- a) Quantity
- b) Durability
- c) Resonance
- d) Profundity

___ 17. Which describes connection between past and present?

- a) Resonance
- b) Relevance
- c) Quantity
- d) Remarkable



___ 18. Which level affects many countries?

- a) Regional
- b) National
- c) Global
- d) Individual

___ 19. Which measures impact on people's lives?

- a) Resonance
- b) Quantity
- c) Durability
- d) Relevance

___ 20. Which criterion helps explain other events?

- a) Revealing
- b) Remarkable
- c) Resonance
- d) Relevance

III. MATCHING TYPE (10 Points)

COLUMN A

- ___ 1. Depth of impact
- ___ 2. Number of people affected
- ___ 3. Length of time effects lasted
- ___ 4. Importance today
- ___ 5. Shared memory

COLUMN B

- A. Relevance
- B. Quantity
- C. Durability
- D. Profundity
- E. Remembered

ANSWER KEY

I. IDENTIFICATION

- Historical Significance
- Relevance
- Quantity
- Profundity
- Durability
- Remembered
- Revealing



- Remarkable
- Subjectivity
- Global Significance

II. MULTIPLE CHOICE

- B
- B
- C
- A
- B
- C
- B

- A
- A
- A
- A
- B

III. MATCHING TYPE

- D
- B
- C
- A
- E



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HIST 111: Readings in the Philippine History

CHAPTER 5: Examination of the Author's Main Argument and Point of View

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Submitted on:

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1. Determining the Author's Purpose

What is it?

- The author's purpose is the reason why a text was created.
- It is what the writer wants to convey to readers: to persuade, to inform, to narrate, or to entertain.

What Gregoria de Jesus says:

- She wrote her notes to narrate her life as the wife of Andres Bonifacio and as the Lakambini (Muse) of the Katipunan.
- She wanted to inform readers about the secrets of the Katipunan that she was part of.

What does this do?

- Helps you understand why an author wrote a text.
- Shows whether a text should be fully believed or read with caution.

Important points:

- A text can have more than one purpose.
- "Mga Tala" both narrates and informs.
- You need to identify the author's main intent.

Types of purpose found in Gregoria de Jesus's text:

Purpose	Explanation	Example
To Narrate	Tells a story or recounts past events	"I am Gregoria de Jesus... I was born... on the 9th of May of the year 1875"
To Inform	Provides information or instructions	"The original ten commandments written by Andres Bonifacio... is in the possession of Mr. Pepe Santos"
To Describe	Paints a picture of a person, place, or event	"Our situation was very dangerous... almost every night our house was full of people"



2. Determining the Author's Main Argument

What is it?

- An argument is the author's claim that something is true.
- It consists of three components: Claim, Evidence, and Warrant.

Using the Toulmin Model of Argument:

A. Claims (Thesis Statement / Conclusion)

What is it?

- The main statement or belief of the author.
- Can be found at the beginning ("I will argue that...") or at the end ("Based on the above...")

Important points:

- The author may state their claim directly.
- It may also only be implied throughout the text.

Gregoria de Jesus's Claim:

- She was an important part of the Katipunan and made significant contributions to the revolution.
- Evidence: She was the keeper of the Katipunan's weapons, documents, and seals.
- Conclusion: She deserves to be recognized as a hero, not just as Bonifacio's wife.

B. Arguments / Evidence

What is it?

- The evidence the author uses to prove their claim.
- Can be personal experience, documents, or witnesses.

Important points:

- Examine whether the evidence is sufficient and valid.
- Ask: "Is this enough to believe the author?"



Evidence from Gregoria de Jesus's text:

Evidence	Explanation
"Almost all the equipment of the Katipunan... were in my keeping"	Proves that she was the keeper of important Katipunan items.
"Secretary Emilio Jacinto lived in our house"	Shows that their home became a center for secret activities.
"Almost every night our house was full of people who followed the voice of the motherland"	Proves that their home served as a meeting place for revolutionaries.

C. Warrant (Connection between Claim and Evidence)

What is it?

- The explanation of why the evidence supports the claim.
- Also called the "research method" or logical connection.

Important points:

- The warrant clarifies for the reader why the argument should be accepted.
- Without a clear warrant, the argument may be weak.

Warrant in Gregoria de Jesus's text:

Because Gregoria personally experienced and witnessed the events of the Katipunan, her narrative should be accepted as a primary source — a direct witness to history.

D. Counter-Arguments / Objections

What is it?

- Possible opposing views or objections to what the author says.
- Does the author address possible doubts?

Important points:

- A good argument considers possible objections.
- If the author does not address them, the argument may have shortcomings.

Possible counter-arguments to the text:

- Others might say that "Mga Tala" was written after the revolution, so there may be forgotten or incorrect memories.
- Others might also say that Gregoria was biased because she was Bonifacio's wife.



Gregoria's response (implied):

- By providing specific details (dates, names of people, places), she shows that the events are still fresh in her memory.

E. Backing (Foundation / Support)

What is it?

- The foundation or additional support for the warrant.
- What else supports the argument besides the evidence itself?

Important points:

- Backing strengthens the argument.
- It can be other documents, witnesses, or historical records.

Backing in Gregoria de Jesus's text:

- Her position as Lakambini of the Katipunan gives her the authority to speak about the secrets of the organization.
- Her direct connection to Andres Bonifacio and Emilio Jacinto proves that she was at the center of the revolution.

F. Qualifiers

What is it?

- Words used to show that the argument is not absolute or without exception.
- Examples: "perhaps," "maybe," "in most cases"

Important points:

- Using qualifiers shows the author's honesty that not everything they say is 100% certain.
- Without qualifiers, the argument may be too absolute.

Qualifiers in Gregoria de Jesus's text:

"At that time, perhaps I was already eighteen years old" — she used "perhaps" because she was not completely sure of her exact age.

"Often, when there was news..." — "often" shows that this did not happen all the time.



3. Questions for Critical Analysis

Question	What is it for?
Why did Gregoria write her notes?	Identify the Author's Purpose
What is her main statement?	Identify the Claim
What evidence did she provide?	Identify the Evidence
Is the evidence enough to believe her?	Assess if the author is Credible
Is there possible bias from Gregoria?	Assess the Objectivity of the text
What did she not mention?	Identify Missing Information

4. Reflection

Think and answer:

- In your opinion, why is "Mga Tala ng Aking Buhay" by Gregoria de Jesus important in studying Philippine History?
- If you were a historian, what would you ask Gregoria de Jesus to verify what she wrote?
- What did you discover about the role of women in the revolution based on Gregoria's text?



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Submitted on:

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I. Determining the Author's Point of View

What is Point of View?

The point of view refers to the author's perspective or position in presenting ideas. It shows how the author sees events, people, and issues. It is influenced by personal experiences, social background, and role in history.

Gregoria de Jesus's Point of View

Gregoria de Jesus writes using a first-person perspective, meaning she uses "I" to narrate her experiences. She was not only the wife of Andres Bonifacio but also an active member of the Katipunan and known as the Lakambini. Because of this, her narration reflects a personal and direct experience of the events during the revolution. Her account is considered a primary source because she personally witnessed and participated in the events she described.

Examples from the Text

In her narration, she mentioned how she gathered important documents, weapons, and the Katipunan seal whenever there was danger. She also described how their house became a meeting place for revolutionaries. She even stated that she was not afraid of danger and was considered a soldier. These statements show that she viewed herself as an active participant in the revolution.

Interpretation

Through her point of view, Gregoria presents herself as brave, responsible, and loyal to her country. Her narration highlights the sacrifices, dangers, and strong sense of patriotism during that time.

Bias in the Point of View

Since Gregoria de Jesus was deeply involved in the Katipunan, her account may show bias. She tends to favor Andres Bonifacio and other revolutionaries. For example, she defended Macario Sakay by stating that he was a true patriot despite being labeled by others as a bandit. This shows that she supports fellow revolutionaries and presents them in a positive way.

Important Insight

Her point of view is valuable because it provides a first-hand account of historical events. However, it should still be analyzed carefully because it may be subjective and influenced by personal experiences.



II. Evaluating Credibility and Reliability

What is Credibility?

Credibility refers to how trustworthy and believable the author is. It helps readers determine whether the information presented can be accepted as reliable.

Why Gregoria de Jesus is Credible

Gregoria de Jesus is considered credible because she had first-hand experience of the events. She provided specific details such as names, places, and situations. She also held an important role in the Katipunan, which gave her authority to speak about its activities. Her narration is also consistent and logically presented.

Limitations of the Text

Despite being credible, her account has limitations. The text was written many years after the revolution, which may affect memory accuracy. Some parts may be influenced by emotions, and certain events were not fully explained. Because of this, her account should be compared with other historical sources.

Conclusion

The text is reliable as a primary source, but it should still be examined carefully. Readers should always consider both the strengths and limitations of historical texts.

III. Key Themes and Messages

One of the main themes is patriotism, shown through the sacrifices made for the country. Courage is also evident as Gregoria faced danger without fear. The text also highlights the important role of women in the revolution, showing that they were not just supporters but active participants. Unity is another theme, emphasizing the importance of working together. Lastly, the text promotes moral values such as respect, discipline, and responsibility.

IV. Application: Understanding Historical Texts

When reading historical texts, it is important to analyze the author's position and involvement in the events. Readers should consider whether the author is an eyewitness or an observer. It is also important to identify emotions in the writing and determine if the author is trying to defend or justify something. Understanding these aspects helps in properly analyzing historical texts.

Activity: Analyze the Author's Point of View

Instructions: Read the excerpts from "Mga Tala ng Aking Buhay" and answer the following questions.



1. How does Gregoria describe her role in the Katipunan?
2. What emotions can you observe in her narration?
3. Do you think her account is biased? Explain your answer.
4. How does her point of view affect how the story is told?
5. Why is it important to understand the author's point of view in history?

Essay Task

Write an essay analyzing Gregoria de Jesus's point of view. Identify her role in the Katipunan, explain how her experiences influenced her writing, determine if her perspective is biased, and discuss how her point of view helps in understanding Philippine history.

Learning Outcomes

At the end of the lesson, students are expected to identify the author's point of view in a historical text, evaluate the credibility of a primary source, analyze bias and perspective in historical writing, and appreciate the role of individuals, especially women, in history.



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HIST 111: Readings in the Philippine History

CHAPTER 6:

Assessment and Analysis of Sources

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I. Module Information

- Subject: Readings in Philippine History
- Topic: Assessment and Analysis of Sources

II. Learning Outcomes

At the end of this module, learners should be able to:

1. Identify different types of historical sources.
2. Analyze sources using context, content, and perspective.
3. Evaluate the reliability and bias of sources.
4. Apply critical thinking in interpreting historical materials.

III. Introduction

History is not just about memorizing events—it is about understanding the past through sources. These sources may include documents, images, artifacts, and media. However, not all sources tell the full truth.

This module will help you develop the ability to analyze, question, and interpret historical sources critically.

IV. Discussion / Lesson Content

A. What are Historical Sources?

Historical sources are materials that provide information about past events. These are used by historians to reconstruct history.

Types of Historical Sources

1. Written Documents

- Letters, diaries, laws, official records
- Focus: Author, purpose, message

2. Photographs

- Captures moments in time
- Focus: People, setting, actions



3. Videos / Films

- Shows movement and real-life events
- Focus: Message, tone, sequence

4. Audio Recordings

- Speeches, interviews
- Focus: Speaker, emotion, intent

5. Editorial Cartoons

- Uses symbols and satire
- Focus: Hidden meaning, opinion

6. Posters

- Designed to persuade
- Focus: Message, audience

7. Maps

- Shows location and geography
- Focus: Accuracy, purpose

8. Artifacts

- Physical objects from the past
- Focus: Material, use, significance

B. How to Analyze Sources

When analyzing a source, ask the following:

1. What is the source?
2. Who created it?
3. When and where was it made?
4. What is happening?
5. Why was it created?
6. Who is the intended audience?
7. What message does it convey?



8. Is there bias or missing information?

C. Evaluating Sources

Not all sources are reliable. Always consider:

- Bias – Does the author have a personal agenda?
- Perspective – Whose side is represented?
- Accuracy – Is the information supported by evidence?

V. Learning Activities

Activity 1: Source Identification

Identify the type of source:

1. A speech recording → _____
2. A political drawing → _____
3. An old coin → _____

Activity 2: Critical Thinking

Answer briefly:

Why is it important to analyze sources before believing them?

VI. Assessment

Short Answer

1. What is a historical source?
2. Give 3 examples of sources.
3. Why do sources need to be analyzed?

Performance Task

Analyze a historical material (photo, document, or video) and write:

- A short description



- Its purpose
- Its reliability

VII. Evaluation Criteria

Criteria	Description
Accuracy	Correct understanding of the source
Analysis	Depth of explanation
Clarity	Clear and organized answers

VIII. Summary

Historical sources are essential in understanding the past. However, they must be carefully analyzed by examining their context, content, and perspective.

By doing this, we can better understand history and avoid misinformation.

IX. Reflection

Complete the sentence:

“I learned that analyzing historical sources is important because _____.”

X. Key Takeaway

History is not just about facts—it is about understanding the truth behind the sources.

XI. Enrichment Activity

Choose one:

- Watch a historical film (e.g., *Heneral Luna*)
- Analyze a document (e.g., Declaration of Independence)

Then answer:

- What did you learn?
- Was the source biased? Why?



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HIST 111: Readings in the Philippine History

CHAPTER 6:

Historical Sources for Assessment and Analysis

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Types of Primarily Historical Sources

I. Overview

This module introduces different types of primary historical sources used in studying Philippine history. These sources help us understand the past from multiple perspectives and allow us to analyze historical events critically.

II. Learning Outcomes

At the end of this module, students should be able to:

1. Identify different types of historical sources.
2. Analyze the content of primary sources.
3. Interpret historical events using evidence.
4. Formulate arguments based on historical texts.

III. Objectives

At the end of the lesson, the students should be able to:

1. Identify the different types of historical sources such as chronicles, memoirs, proclamations, speeches, cartoons, paintings, and films.
2. Explain the characteristics and purposes of each type of historical source.
3. Differentiate the various historical sources based on their content, form, and perspective.
4. Analyze selected primary sources to determine their reliability, bias, and significance.
5. Appreciate the importance of using multiple sources in understanding Philippine history.

IV. Lesson Proper

A. What are Historical Sources?

Historical sources are materials that provide information about the past. These can be written, visual, or oral.



V. Types of Historical Sources

a. Chronicle

Example: Customs of the Tagalogs by Juan de Plasencia

- A chronicle is a systematic written record of events, beliefs, and practices, usually arranged in the order they happened. Describes early Filipino beliefs and practices.
- Mentions spiritual leaders like:
 - o Catalonan (priest)
 - o Mangagauay (witch healer)
 - o Mangkukulam (sorcerer)
 - o Aswang (mythical creature)

b. Declaration of Principles

Example: Kartilya ng Katipunan by Emilio Jacinto

- A set of moral and ethical teachings. This type of source contains rules, values, and guiding principles of a group or movement.
- Promotes:
 - o Equality of all people
 - o Love for others
 - o Respect for women
 - o Patriotism

c. Memoir

Example: Mga Gunita ng Himagsikan by Emilio Aguinaldo

- A memoir is a personal recollection of past events, written by someone who experienced them. It provides a first-hand account, making it rich in detail. However it can be subjective or selective.
- Describes battles and experiences during the revolution.



d. Proclamation

Example: Declaration of Philippine Independence (June 12, 1898)

- A proclamation is an official public announcement, often political. It uses formal and persuasive language to gain support and legitimacy.
- Official announcement declaring freedom from Spain.
- Led by Emilio Aguinaldo

e. Cartoons (Political Caricatures)

Example: Works by Alfred McCoy and Alfredo Roces

- Political cartoons are visual sources that express opinions through images.
- Visual representations of political issues.
- Often use humor or exaggeration.
- During the American period, cartoons showed: Colonial control and Filipino resistance

f. Speech

Example: Speech before the U.S. Congress by Corazon Aquino (1986)

- A speech is a spoken message meant to persuade or inform an audience.
- Aquino's Speech Highlights:
 - o Democracy
 - o Freedom
 - o People Power Revolution

g. Paintings

- Paintings are visual interpretations of historical events or emotions.

Examples:

- **Spoliarium by Juan Luna**
- Oppression of Filipinos under Spain
- Suffering and injustice



- Making of the Philippine Flag by Fernando Amorsolo
- Patriotism
- Unity and hope

h. Films

- Films are audio-visual representations of history. It combines image, narration, reenactment

Example: Raiders of the Sulu Sea (2008 documentary)

- Shows:
 - o Spanish colonization in Mindanao
 - o Slave raiding
 - o Maritime warfare



QUIZ TIME!!

Part I: Multiple Choice (20 items)

Choose the correct answer.

1. What are historical sources?
 - a. Fictional stories
 - b. Materials that provide information about the past
 - c. Future predictions
 - d. Scientific formulas
2. Which of the following is NOT a type of historical source?
 - a. Chronicle
 - b. Memoir
 - c. Novel
 - d. Proclamation
3. A chronicle is best described as:
 - a. A fictional story
 - b. A written record arranged in order of events
 - c. A speech
 - d. A drawing
4. Who wrote *Customs of the Tagalogs*?
 - a. Emilio Aguinaldo
 - b. Juan de Plasencia
 - c. Emilio Jacinto
 - d. Fernando Amorsolo
5. What does a chronicle usually describe?
 - a. Future events
 - b. Imaginary stories
 - c. Events, beliefs, and practices
 - d. Scientific data
6. Which of the following is a spiritual leader mentioned in early Filipino beliefs?
 - a. President
 - b. Catalonan
 - c. Soldier
 - d. Mayor
7. The *Kartilya ng Katipunan* is an example of:
 - a. Chronicle
 - b. Memoir
 - c. Declaration of Principles
 - d. Film



8. Who wrote the *Kartilya ng Katipunan*?
 - a. Emilio Aguinaldo
 - b. Juan Luna
 - c. Emilio Jacinto
 - d. Corazon Aquino
9. A declaration of principles contains:
 - a. Stories
 - b. Moral and ethical teachings
 - c. Drawings
 - d. Songs
10. Which value is promoted in the *Kartilya*?
 - a. Selfishness
 - b. Equality
 - c. Greed
 - d. Hatred
11. A memoir is:
 - a. A fictional story
 - b. A personal recollection
 - c. A painting
 - d. A speech
12. Who wrote *Mga Gunita ng Himagsikan*?
 - a. Emilio Aguinaldo
 - b. Juan Luna
 - c. Alfred McCoy
 - d. Corazon Aquino
13. A memoir is considered subjective because:
 - a. It is written by many people
 - b. It is based on personal experiences
 - c. It is always fictional
 - d. It has no details
14. A proclamation is:
 - a. A personal diary
 - b. An official public announcement
 - c. A painting
 - d. A cartoon
15. The Declaration of Philippine Independence was proclaimed in:
 - a. 1896
 - b. 1898



- c. 1901
 - d. 1986
16. Political cartoons usually express:
- a. Scientific facts
 - b. Opinions through images
 - c. Personal memories
 - d. Laws
17. Political cartoons often use:
- a. Humor and exaggeration
 - b. Music
 - c. Silence
 - d. Numbers
18. A speech is meant to:
- a. Entertain only
 - b. Persuade or inform
 - c. Confuse people
 - d. Draw pictures
19. Which is an example of a painting?
- a. Speech before Congress
 - b. Spoliarium
 - c. Kartilya
 - d. Declaration
20. Films are considered historical sources because they:
- a. Are fictional
 - b. Combine visuals and narration
 - c. Are always cartoons
 - d. Ignore history

Part II: True or False (15 items)

Write TRUE if correct, FALSE if not.

- 21. Historical sources provide information about the past.
- 22. A memoir is always objective.
- 23. Chronicles are arranged in order of events.
- 24. Kartilya ng Katipunan promotes equality.
- 25. A proclamation is a private document.
- 26. Political cartoons use images to express ideas.
- 27. Speeches cannot influence people.



- 28. Paintings can reflect emotions and history.
- 29. Films combine sound and visuals.
- 30. The Catalonan is a spiritual leader.
- 31. Memoirs are written by eyewitnesses.
- 32. Political cartoons are always serious and never humorous.
- 33. The Declaration of Independence is a proclamation.
- 34. Paintings cannot show historical events.
- 35. Films can depict historical events.

Part III: Identification (15 items)

Write the correct answer.

- 36. A systematic written record of events arranged in order.
- 37. A personal recollection of past experiences.
- 38. An official public announcement.
- 39. A visual source that uses humor or exaggeration.
- 40. A spoken message meant to persuade or inform.
- 41. A visual interpretation of historical events or emotions.
- 42. Audio-visual representation of history.
- 43. Author of *Customs of the Tagalogs*.
- 44. Author of *Kartilya ng Katipunan*.
- 45. Author of *Mga Gunita ng Himagsikan*.
- 46. The mythical creature mentioned in early Filipino beliefs.
- 47. A witch healer in early Filipino society.
- 48. A priest or spiritual leader in early Filipino beliefs.
- 49. The painting showing oppression under Spain by Juan Luna.
- 50. The documentary showing Spanish colonization in Mindanao.



ANSWER KEY

Part I: Multiple Choice (1–20)

1. **b**

2. **c**

3. **b**

4. **b**

5. **c**

6. **b**

7. **c**

8. **c**

9. **b**

10. **b**

11. **b**

12. **a**

13. **b**

14. **b**

15. **b**

16. **b**

17. **a**

18. **b**

19. **b**

20. **b**

Part II: True or False (21–35)

21. **TRUE**

22. **FALSE**

23. **TRUE**

24. **TRUE**

25. **FALSE**



26. **TRUE**

27. **FALSE**

28. **TRUE**

29. **TRUE**

30. **TRUE**

31. **TRUE**

32. **FALSE**

33. **TRUE**

34. **FALSE**

35. **TRUE**

Part III: Identification (36–50)

36. **Chronicle**

37. **Memoir**

38. **Proclamation**

39. **Political Cartoon (Caricature)**

40. **Speech**

41. **Painting**

42. **Film**

43. **Juan de Plasencia**

44. **Emilio Jacinto**

45. **Emilio Aguinaldo**

46. **Aswang**

47. **Mangagauay**

48. **Catalonan**

49. **Spoliarium**

50. **Raiders of the Sulu Sea**



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COLLEGE OF COMPUTER STUDIES



HIST 111: Reading in the Philippine History

CHAPTER 7:

The First Mass Site in the Philippines

Submitted by:

REPORTER:

PEREZ, MARIA LIZA T.

Submitted to:

MA'AM HILDA PURA

Submitted on:

APRIL 27, 2026



Learning Outcomes:

At the end of this chapter, the student is expected to:

1. Demonstrates the ability to formulate arguments in favor or against a particular issue using primary sources

Chapter Outline:

The First Voyage Round the World

by Antonio Pigafetta

Butuan or Limasawa? The site of the First Mass in the Philippines:

A Reexamination of the Evidence

By Miguel A. Bernard

Learning Objectives:

Here are four key learning objectives for this topic:

1. To analyze Antonio Pigafetta's account as a primary source describing the first voyage around the world and early Filipino life.
2. To understand the key events of Magellan's expedition, including their arrival in the Philippines and interactions with local communities.
3. To examine the debate on the location of the First Mass in the Philippines (Butuan vs. Limasawa) using historical evidence.
4. To develop the ability to evaluate historical claims and form arguments using primary and secondary sources.

CHAPTER 7: The First Voyage Round the World

Why It Is Important

The account of *The First Voyage Round the World* by Antonio Pigafetta is important because it provides valuable historical, cultural, and religious insights about the early Philippines.



- Provides a first-hand historical account
The narrative is one of the earliest documented descriptions of the Philippines during the arrival of Ferdinand Magellan in 1521.
- Shows early Filipino culture and lifestyle
Pigafetta described local customs, food, clothing, and daily life, helping us understand pre-colonial society.
- Documents the first contact between Filipinos and Europeans
It records interactions and relationships formed with local leaders like Rajah Kolambu.
- Records a major religious event in Philippine history
It includes the first Christian mass held in Limasawa, marking the start of Christianity in the country.

How It Works

The account works by presenting a detailed and chronological narrative of events, allowing readers to understand the experiences and observations of Antonio Pigafetta during the voyage.

- Through detailed observation and narration
Pigafetta carefully describes what he saw—people's appearance, daily activities, food sources, and environment.
- By documenting interactions and exchanges
The text explains how communication happened using gestures, interpreters, and gift-giving between the explorers and locals.
- By explaining unfamiliar things using comparisons
He compares local items (like coconut products) to European equivalents to make them easier to understand.
- By recording events chronologically
The account follows a timeline of events during the expedition led by Ferdinand Magellan, showing what happened step by step.

Goals of *The First Voyage Round the World* by Antonio Pigafetta

The goal of *The First Voyage Round the World* by Antonio Pigafetta is to document and share a detailed record of the expedition led by Ferdinand Magellan, including the places they visited, the people they encountered, and the experiences they observed during the journey.

It specifically aims to:

1. Record historical events of the first circumnavigation of the world.
2. Describe new lands and cultures, especially in the Philippines.



3. Report interactions between Europeans and indigenous peoples.
4. Preserve important moments, such as the first mass in Limasawa.

The First Voyage Around the World

By: Antonio Pigafetta

Overview

This lesson is based on the firsthand account of Antonio Pigafetta, a chronicler who joined the expedition of Ferdinand Magellan. His writings describe the journey of the first circumnavigation of the world and the early encounters between Europeans and the people of the islands now known as the Philippines.

Key Content

Lifestyle of Early Inhabitants

- People lived freely without rulers or strict laws
- They wore simple clothing or none at all
- Used palm leaves and natural materials for shelter
- Strong and well-built physically
- Depended on nature for food and daily needs

Importance of Coconut Trees

- Provided food, drink, oil, vinegar, and milk
- Used for making ropes and building materials
- One tree could support an entire family

Daily Life and Skills

- Skilled in fishing using small boats made of palm leaves
- Used bone hooks to catch fish
- Made tools from wood and natural materials
- Lived peacefully, though some were cautious of outsiders

Arrival of the Expedition (1521)

- The expedition reached the island of Zamal (Philippines) in March 1521
- Locals welcomed the explorers with food and hospitality
- Exchange of goods began between both groups

Cultural Exchange

- Locals gave fish, fruits, and palm wine
- Explorers gave mirrors, bells, caps, and other items
- Leaders showed curiosity about ships, weapons, and technology



- Both groups learned from each other's way of life

First Mass in the Philippines

- Held on Easter Sunday, March 31, 1521, in Limasawa
- Local leaders participated respectfully
- A cross was planted as a symbol of Christianity
- Marked the introduction of Christianity in the country

Significance of the Voyage

- First recorded European contact with Filipinos
- Documentation of early Filipino life before colonization
- Start of cultural exchange between East and West
- Introduction of Christianity in the Philippines
- Proof of the first circumnavigation of the world

Key Insight

This voyage shows how different cultures met for the first time—sometimes with curiosity, sometimes with caution—but it ultimately opened the world to exploration, trade, and cultural exchange.

Quiz: The First Voyage Around the World (Antonio Pigafetta)

I. Multiple Choice

Instructions: Choose the letter of the correct answer.

1. Who wrote the account of the first voyage around the world?

- A. Ferdinand Magellan
- B. Antonio Pigafetta
- C. Christopher Columbus
- D. Enrique of Malacca

2. What expedition is described in the text?

- A. Voyage to America
- B. First circumnavigation of the world
- C. Discovery of Africa
- D. Trade expedition to China

3. In what year did the expedition reach the Philippines?

- A. 1519
- B. 1521
- C. 1530
- D. 1545

4. What island did they first see in the Philippines?

- A. Cebu
- B. Zamal



- C. Luzon
 - D. Mindanao
-

5. How did the early inhabitants live?
- A. With kings and strict laws
 - B. Freely without rulers
 - C. In castles
 - D. In cities
-

6. What did the people wear?
- A. Modern clothes
 - B. Armor
 - C. Little or no clothing
 - D. Uniforms
-

7. What material was commonly used for shelter and tools?
- A. Iron
 - B. Stone only
 - C. Palm leaves and wood
 - D. Plastic
-

8. What was a major food source of the people?
- A. Bread
 - B. Coconuts and fruits
 - C. Pasta
 - D. Chocolate
-

9. What did coconut trees provide?
- A. Only fruit
 - B. Only wood
 - C. Food, drink, oil, and materials
 - D. Only shelter
-

10. How did the people fish?
- A. With guns
 - B. With nets only
 - C. With bone hooks and small boats
 - D. With traps made of metal
-

11. What type of boats did they use?
- A. Large ships
 - B. Submarines
 - C. Small palm-leaf boats
 - D. Wooden airplanes



12. What did the natives give to the explorers?

- A. Weapons
 - B. Gold bars
 - C. Fruits, fish, and palm wine
 - D. Horses
-

13. What did the explorers give to the natives?

- A. Mirrors, bells, caps
 - B. Weapons only
 - C. Books
 - D. Land
-

14. How did the natives react to Spanish weapons and ships?

- A. Not interested
 - B. Fearful and amazed
 - C. Angry
 - D. Confused but violent
-

15. What important event happened on March 31, 1521?

- A. War began
 - B. First Mass in the Philippines
 - C. Voyage ended
 - D. Gold was discovered
-

16. Where was the first Mass held?

- A. Manila
 - B. Cebu
 - C. Limasawa
 - D. Palawan
-

17. What symbol was planted after the Mass?

- A. Flag
 - B. Statue
 - C. Cross
 - D. Sword
-

18. What did the Mass represent?

- A. Trade agreement
 - B. Introduction of Christianity
 - C. War victory
 - D. Political meeting
-

19. What did Pigafetta observe about cultural exchange?

- A. No interaction
- B. Only war happened



- C. Trade and sharing of goods
- D. No communication

20. Why is Pigafetta's account important?

- A. It is a legend
- B. It is a fictional story
- C. It is a primary historical source
- D. It is a song

Answer Key

- 1. B
- 2. B
- 3. B
- 4. B
- 5. B
- 6. C
- 7. C
- 8. B
- 9. C
- 10. C
- 11. C
- 12. C
- 13. A
- 14. B
- 15. B
- 16. C
- 17. C
- 18. B
- 19. C
- 20. C



Butuan or Limasawa? The Site of the First Mass in the Philippines

Based on Miguel A. Bernard's Reexamination of Evidence (1981)

Overview

This reading is based on the study of Miguel A. Bernard published in *Kinaadman: A Journal of Southern Philippines* (1981). It discusses the historical controversy about the exact location of the first Catholic Mass in the Philippines held during Magellan's expedition in 1521.

Key Content

The Controversy

There are two main claims about the location of the first Mass:

- **Limasawa Claim**
 - A small island in Southern Leyte
 - Supported by many modern historians
 - Identified as "Mazaua" in Pigafetta's account
- **Butuan Claim**
 - Located at the mouth of the Agusan River (Mindanao)
 - Supported by local tradition and historical interpretation
 - Associated with Masao, Butuan

The Butuan Tradition

- Strong belief that the first Mass happened in Butuan
- Tradition existed for over **300 years (17th–19th centuries)**
- A monument was built in **1872** near the Agusan River
- The monument stated that Magellan celebrated Mass there in 1521

Meaning of the Monument

- Built to honor Magellan's arrival
- Supported by local church leaders and Spanish authorities
- Reinforced the belief that Butuan was the site of the first Mass

Historical Support for Butuan

17th Century Accounts

- Early Jesuit historians supported the Butuan claim
- One important writer: Father Francisco Colin, S.J.
- His work described Magellan's arrival and Mass in the area identified as Butuan



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BAGONG PILIPINAS

HIST 111: READINGS IN THE PHILIPPINE HISTORY

“THE 18TH CENTURY”

CHAPTER 7:

The First Mass Site in the Philippines

Submitted by:

REPORTER:

MARQUEZ, KAYE M.

BSIT 3-F3

Submitted to:

MA'AM HILDA PURA

Submitted on:

APRIL 27, 2026



THE 18th CENTURY

Learning Outcomes:

At the end of this chapter, the student is expected to:

1. Evaluate the primary and secondary sources regarding the site of the First Mass in the Philippines.
2. Trace the historiography and understand the shift in scholarly consensus from Butuan to Limasawa.
3. Develop critical thinking skills by analyzing geographical, navigational, and textual evidence from historical voyages.
4. Analyze the mechanisms of historical error, specifically how the reliance on secondary sources and early misattributions perpetuated the Butuan tradition for over three centuries.
5. Recognize the independent historical and archaeological significance of Butuan as a highly advanced, pre-colonial maritime trading hub in the Philippines.

Chapter Outline:

CHAPTER 7: The Site of the First Mass

1. Introduction: The Significance of the First Mass
2. The Butuan Tradition (17th to 19th Century)
3. The Shift in Scholarly Opinion
4. The Evidence for Limasawa
 - a. Francisco Albo's Log-Book
 - b. Antonio Pigafetta's Account and Maps
 - c. The Argument from Omission
5. Confirmatory Evidence: The Legazpi Expedition
6. Why the Butuan Tradition Persisted
7. The True Importance of Butuan

Learning objectives:

Here are the key learning objectives for this topic:

1. Identify the key historians and primary accounts responsible for the Butuan and Limasawa traditions.



2. Analyze the concrete evidence provided by Francisco Albo's navigational log-book and Antonio Pigafetta's day-by-day testimony.
 3. Understand the distinct historical and archaeological importance of Butuan independent of the First Mass controversy, recognizing its role as a pre-colonial trading powerhouse.
 4. Evaluate the reasons why historical errors persist over time by analyzing how secondary copying and Maximilian of Transylvania's erroneous 1523 account cemented the Butuan tradition for three centuries.
 5. Examine how later historical voyages, specifically the 1565 Legazpi expedition, serve as crucial confirmatory evidence to distinguish the distinct geographical locations of Mazaua and Butuan.
-

Pre-Test: What Do You Know?

Instructions: Before reading the chapter, answer these true-or-false questions to gauge your prior knowledge. Write **T** if the statement is true; otherwise, write **F**.

1. ____ The First Catholic Mass in the Philippines was held on Christmas Day, 1521.
 2. ____ For over 300 years, historians falsely believed the first mass happened in Butuan.
 3. ____ Antonio Pigafetta was the primary eyewitness and chronicler of Magellan's expedition.
 4. ____ Limasawa is a large, river-dominated landmass located in northern Mindanao.
 5. ____ The Legazpi expedition of 1565 confirmed that Mazaua and Butuan were the exact same place.
 6. ____ Francisco Albo's highly technical navigational log-book recorded coordinates that perfectly matched the location of Butuan.
 7. ____ Antonio Pigafetta recorded the presence of two native kings—the King of Mazaua and the visiting King of Butuan—during their 7-day stay at Mazaua.
 8. ____ Maximilian of Transylvania was an eyewitness to the First Mass and wrote the most accurate geographical account of the event.
 9. ____ The archaeological discovery of the Balanghai boats confirms Butuan's historical status as a highly advanced pre-colonial trading center.
 10. ____ Because the historical error was so widely accepted, Spanish authorities erected a brick monument commemorating the First Mass in Limasawa in 1872.
-



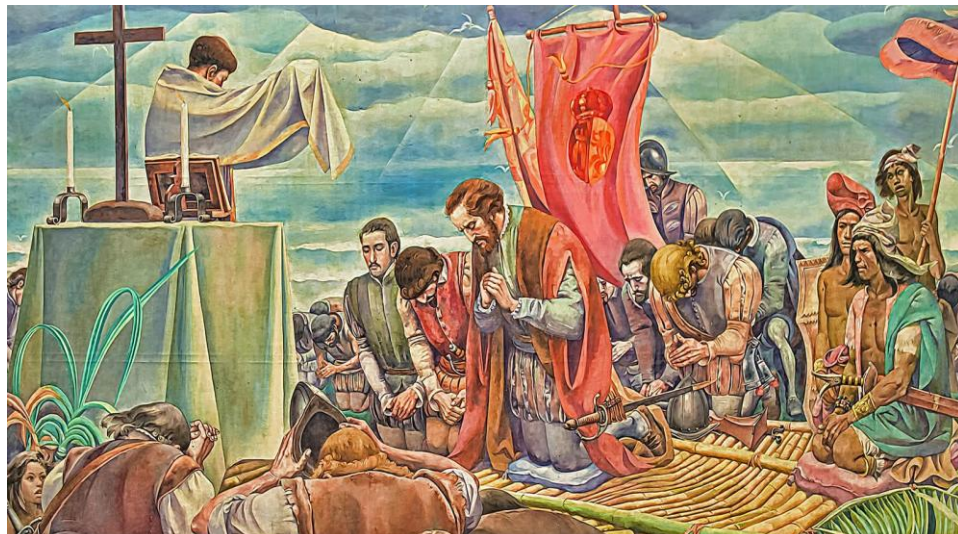
Answer Key:

1. **F** - (It was held on Easter Sunday, March 31, 1521.)
2. **T** - (Historians believed the Butuan tradition from the 17th to the late 19th century.)
3. **T** - (He was the primary chronicler of the expedition.)
4. **F** - (Limasawa is a small, tadpole-shaped island in Southern Leyte; Butuan is the river-dominated landmass in Mindanao.)
5. **F** - (The Legazpi expedition's guides confirmed Mazaua and Butuan were entirely separate, distant places.)
6. **F** - (Albo's log-book plotted the coordinates at 9 and 2/3 degrees North, matching Mazaua/Limasawa, and made no mention of Butuan.)
7. **T** - (Rajah Kolambu and Rajah Siau were both present.)
8. **F** - (He was not an eyewitness, and his 1523 account incorrectly claimed the mass happened in "Subuth" or Cebu.)
9. **T** - (These artifacts prove Butuan was a wealthy maritime hub independent of the First Mass controversy.)
10. **F** - (The 1872 brick monument was erected in Magallanes, near Butuan, not Limasawa.)

CHAPTER 7: The First Mass Site in the Philippines

1. Introduction: The Significance of the First Mass

The First Catholic Mass in the Philippines, held on Easter Sunday, March 31, 1521, marked the introduction of Christianity to the archipelago. Led by Father Pedro de Valderrama, the chaplain of Ferdinand Magellan's expedition, this event is a cornerstone of Philippine historical identity. However, for centuries, the exact location of this monumental event was the subject of intense historical debate.



2. The Butuan Tradition

For over three centuries (from the 17th to the late 19th century), the undisputed historical consensus was that the First Mass took place in Butuan, a riverine settlement in northern Mindanao.

- **The Originators:** This tradition was heavily influenced by the writings of two prominent Jesuit historians: **Fr. Francisco Colin** (who wrote *Labor Evangelica* in 1663) and **Fr. Francisco Combés** (who wrote *Historia de Mindanao y Jolo* in 1667).
- **The Systemic Error:** These historians did not have access to the original, unedited manuscripts of the Magellan expedition. They relied on secondary summaries, misread the routes, and made incorrect geographical assumptions. Because they were highly respected scholars, later writers copied their accounts blindly, cementing a massive historical error.

- **The Monument:** The belief was so deeply entrenched in the national consciousness that in 1872, Spanish provincial authorities erected a brick monument in Magallanes, near Butuan, explicitly commemorating the First Mass.



3. The Shift in Scholarly Opinion

At the dawn of the 20th century, a systematic re-evaluation of history occurred. The scholarly opinion shifted dramatically from Butuan to **Limasawa**, a small island municipality in Southern Leyte.

- **The Catalyst:** The shift was triggered by the rediscovery, translation, and intensive study of the original, unedited primary sources: Pigafetta's full manuscript and Albo's log-book.
- **Key Figures:** The Spanish scholar **Fr. Pablo Pastells** initially began noticing discrepancies in the Butuan claim. Later, American historians **Emma Blair and James Alexander Robertson** published their massive 55-volume work, *The Philippine Islands, 1493–1898*, which provided direct English translations of Pigafetta's text. By comparing the raw data, scholars realized the three-century Butuan tradition was a geographical impossibility.

4. The Evidence for Limasawa

The evidence pointing to Limasawa (referred to historically as "Mazaua") rests on the meticulous, systematic records kept by the eyewitnesses of the Magellan expedition.

- A. The Evidence of Albo's Log-Book** Francisco Albo was the *contra-maestre* (pilot) of Magellan's flagship, the *Trinidad*. He kept a strict navigational log of the voyage.
 - **The Coordinates:** He recorded that they sailed south along the coast of Seilani (Leyte) and turned southwest to a small island called **Mazava**, which he accurately plotted at a latitude of **9 and 2/3 degrees North**.

- **The Route:** Albo's highly technical log makes absolutely no mention of sailing further south to Mindanao or entering the Butuan area.



B. The Evidence of Pigafetta Antonio Pigafetta was the primary chronicler and official record-keeper of the expedition. His rich, day-by-day narrative perfectly aligns with the geography of Limasawa.

- **The Seven Days:** Pigafetta details a 7-day stay at an island called "Mazaua" (March 28 to April 4, 1521). It was here that the First Mass was celebrated and a large wooden cross was planted on the highest hill on Easter Sunday.
- **The Two Kings:** Pigafetta explicitly notes that the "King of Mazaua" (Rajah Kolambu) was present. Interestingly, another ruler was there visiting him: his brother, the **King of Butuan** (Rajah Siaiu). Magellan and his men met the King of Butuan *at* Mazaua.
- **The Maps:** Pigafetta was also a cartographer. His hand-drawn sketches clearly depict Mazaua as a small, tadpole-shaped island located near Leyte and Bohol, completely separate from the large landmass of Mindanao.





C. The Argument from Omission

- The geographical layout of Butuan is dominated by the massive **Agusan River** delta. If Mazaua were Butuan, it would be impossible for an observant chronicler like Pigafetta to miss it. Yet, Pigafetta meticulously describes the island's terrain, houses, and resources, but never mentions a river at Mazaua.

5. Confirmatory Evidence: The Legazpi Expedition

Forty-four years after Magellan's death, the Miguel López de Legazpi expedition arrived in the Philippines (1565).

- Legazpi's men specifically searched for "Mazaua" based on Magellan's accounts.
- Their local guides and pilots clearly understood that Mazaua (an island near Panaon and Leyte) and Butuan (a trading settlement on the island of Mindanao) were two entirely separate, distant places. They visited Mazaua first, and only later sent a small contingent down to Butuan.

6. Why the Butuan Tradition Persisted

How does a historical error survive for 300 years? It functions much like a game of "telephone."

- **Second-hand copying:** Historians relied on earlier historians instead of digging into primary sources.
- **Maximilian of Transylvania:** In 1523, a courtier named Maximilian published *De Moluccis Insulis*, the very first printed account of the voyage. Though he interviewed returning survivors, he was not an eyewitness himself. His letter placed the First Mass in "Subuth" (Cebu) and wildly mixed up geographical facts, creating a confusing foundation that misled historians for generations.

7. The True Importance of Butuan

Rejecting the First Mass claim does **not** degrade Butuan's cultural or historical importance; in fact, looking closely at the primary texts elevates it.

- **The Golden King:** Pigafetta described the visiting King of Butuan as the "finest looking man" they saw, detailing his silk garments, a dagger with a golden hilt, and reporting that even his teeth were decorated with gold.
- **Archaeological Hub:** Decades later, archaeological discoveries in the Agusan River delta uncovered the famous **Balanghai boats** and the **Golden Tara**. These physical artifacts prove that long before the Spanish arrived, pre-colonial Butuan was already a wildly wealthy, technologically advanced, and crucial hub for inter-island and foreign maritime trade.



Activity 1: Source Detective Challenge (25 points)

Objective: Analyze historical sources and determine the most accurate site of the First Mass.

Instructions: Divide the class into 3–5 members per group. Each group will act as “history detectives.” They will examine the given evidence from the chapter:

- **Francisco Albo’s Log-Book**
- **Antonio Pigafetta’s Account and Maps**
- **Maximilian of Transylvania’s Account**
- **Legazpi Expedition Evidence**

Each group must create a short 2–3 minutes presentation answering:

1. **What source was assigned to your group?**
2. **Is it a primary or secondary source?**
3. **What evidence does it provide?**
4. **Does it support Butuan or Limasawa? Why?**

Scoring Criteria (25 points):
• Accuracy of explanation – 10 points
• Analysis and reasoning – 10 points
• Teamwork and presentation – 5 points

Activity 2: Debate – Butuan vs. Limasawa (25 points)

Objective: Develop critical thinking and communication skills through debate.

Instructions: Divide the class into 2 teams:

- **Team Butuan – Defend the traditional claim that the First Mass happened in Butuan.**



- **Team Limasawa – Defend the modern historical consensus that it happened in Limasawa.**

Each team will be given 5 minutes to prepare and 3 minutes to present their arguments. After both sides present, the teacher may ask follow-up questions.

Guide Questions:

- **What evidence supports your assigned side?**
- **Why did historians believe this claim for so long?**
- **Which source is the most reliable?**

Scoring Criteria (25 points):
• Strength of arguments – 10 points
• Use of historical evidence – 10 points
• Delivery and teamwork – 5 points

Quiz time!!!

I. IDENTIFICATION (10 Points) Instructions: Identify the person, place, or concept being described in each statement. Write your answer on the space provided.

1. _____ The Spanish scholar and Jesuit who initially defended the Butuan tradition but later shifted his opinion to Limasawa after restudying the original documents.
2. _____ The pilot of Magellan's flagship who kept a highly technical navigational log-book of the voyage.
3. _____ The massive geographical feature (a river delta) that is notably missing from Antonio Pigafetta's description of Mazaua.
4. _____ The Italian chronicler who provided a detailed, day-by-day eyewitness account of the Magellan expedition.
5. _____ The specific date (Day, Month, Year) when the First Catholic Mass in the Philippines was celebrated.
6. _____ The Jesuit historian who wrote *Labor Evangelica* in 1663 and was one of the primary originators of the Butuan error.
7. _____ The author of *De Moluccis Insulis* (1523), the first published account of the voyage, which contained second-hand geographical errors.
8. _____ The wealthy leader, described as the "finest looking man" adorned in gold, who was only visiting Mazaua when Magellan arrived.



9. _____ The island municipality in Southern Leyte now officially recognized by historical consensus as the true site of the First Mass.
10. _____ The Spanish explorer who led an expedition in 1565; his pilots confirmed that Mazaua and Butuan were entirely different and distant places.
-

II. MULTIPLE CHOICE (10 Points) Instructions: Read each question carefully and write the letter of the correct answer on the space provided.

_____ **1. What was the latitudinal coordinate of "Mazava" as accurately recorded in Francisco Albo's log-book?**

- a) 10 and 1/2 degrees North
- b) 9 and 2/3 degrees North
- c) 8 and 1/4 degrees North
- d) 11 degrees North

_____ **2. American historians Emma Blair and James Alexander Robertson contributed to the Limasawa shift by doing what?**

- a) Excavating the Balanghai boats in Butuan.
- b) Finding Magellan's lost wooden cross.
- c) Publishing a massive 55-volume work with direct English translations of Pigafetta's account.
- d) Destroying the 1872 Spanish monument in Magallanes.

_____ **3. How many days did Pigafetta record the Magellan expedition stayed on the island of Mazaua?**

- a) Three days
- b) Seven days
- c) Ten days
- d) Fourteen days

_____ **4. Which of the following is the strongest "Argument from Omission" that disproves the Butuan tradition?**

- a) Pigafetta never mentions navigating a massive river delta, which dominates Butuan's geography.
- b) Pigafetta never mentions the planting of a wooden cross.



c) Pigafetta never mentions meeting any native kings.

d) Pigafetta never mentions any gold found in the area.

_____ **5. According to geographical analysis, what is the distinct shape of Limasawa island?**

a) Crescent-shaped

b) Star-shaped

c) Tadpole-shaped

d) Rectangle-shaped

_____ **6. What physical structure was erected by Spanish authorities in 1872 because the historical error was so deeply entrenched?**

a) A cathedral in Cebu.

b) A brick monument in Magallanes, near Butuan.

c) A lighthouse in Limasawa.

d) A gold statue of Rajah Siaiu.

_____ **7. In Maximilian of Transylvania's erroneous 1523 account, where did he claim the First Mass took place?**

a) Subuth (Cebu)

b) Homonhon

c) Mactan

d) Manila

_____ **8. Rejecting Butuan as the site of the First Mass does not degrade its historical importance because archaeological discoveries proved it was:**

a) The site of the first university in the Philippines.

b) A wealthy, highly advanced pre-colonial hub for maritime trade.

c) The birthplace of Miguel López de Legazpi.

d) The capital of the Spanish colonial government.

_____ **9. Which 17th-century historian wrote *Historia de Mindanao y Jolo* (1667) and, alongside Colin, helped cement the Butuan tradition?**

a) Fr. Pedro de Valderrama

b) Fr. Francisco Combés

c) Fr. Valentin



d) Fr. Joaquin Martinez de Zuñiga

_____ 10. Magellan's flagship, piloted by Francisco Albo, was named:

- a) Victoria
- b) Concepcion
- c) San Antonio
- d) Trinidad

III. MATCHING TYPE (10 Points) Instructions: Match the descriptions in **Column A** with the correct terms/names in **Column B**. Write the letter of your answer on the space provided.

COLUMN A

_____ 1. The native name of the island of Leyte as recorded in Albo's log-book.

_____ 2. The local name for the strong east wind mentioned in the geography of Limasawa.

_____ 3. The island where the Magellan expedition stayed for eight days before heading to Mazaua.

_____ 4. The year the Legazpi expedition arrived in the Philippines.

_____ 5. The ancient pre-colonial wooden boats excavated in the Agusan River delta.

_____ 6. The official chaplain of Magellan's expedition who officiated the First Mass.

_____ 7. The exact date Pigafetta recorded the expedition leaving Mazaua bound for Cebu.

_____ 8. The island where Maximilian of Transylvania incorrectly claimed the mass happened.

_____ 9. The King of Mazaua who hosted Magellan and his men.

_____ 10. The only ship from Magellan's fleet to successfully return to Spain and circumnavigate the globe (from which Maximilian interviewed survivors).



COLUMN B

A. April 4, 1521

B. Balanghais

C. Seilani

D. Homonhon

E. 1565

F. Fr. Pedro de Valderrama

G. Subuth

H. Dumagsa

I. Victoria

J. Rajah Kolambu

IV. ENUMERATION (5 Points)

Instructions: Enumerate the answers asked in each item.

- 1. Give the two primary eyewitness sources used to prove Limasawa as the First Mass site.**

- 2. Give the two native rulers present at Mazaua during Magellan's stay.**

- 3. Give the two Jesuit historians who helped spread the Butuan tradition.**

- 4. Give the two important archaeological discoveries that prove Butuan's importance as a trading hub.**

- 5. Give the two islands closely associated with the First Mass journey before and after Mazaua.**



V. FILL IN THE BLANKS (5 Points)

Instructions: Fill in the blanks with the correct answer.

1. The First Catholic Mass in the Philippines was celebrated on _____ Sunday, March 31, 1521.
2. Francisco Albo plotted Mazava at _____ and 2/3 degrees North.
3. Antonio Pigafetta described Mazaua as a small _____ - shaped island.
4. The 1565 expedition led by _____ confirmed that Mazaua and Butuan were different places.
5. The Agusan River _____ dominates the geography of Butuan.

VI. SEQUENCING (5 Points)

Instructions: Arrange the following events in chronological order by writing numbers **1–5**.

- _____ **Magellan's expedition celebrated the First Mass in Mazaua.**
- _____ **The Legazpi expedition arrived in the Philippines.**
- _____ **Spanish authorities erected the Butuan monument.**
- _____ **Maximilian of Transylvania published De Moluccis Insulis.**
- _____ **Blair and Robertson published The Philippine Islands.**

VII. WHO AM I? (5 Points)

Instructions: Identify the person being described.

1. I am the Italian chronicler who recorded the daily events of Magellan's expedition.



2. I am the pilot of Magellan's flagship who kept a technical navigational log-book.

3. I am the chaplain who officiated the First Catholic Mass in the Philippines.

4. I am the king of Mazaua who welcomed Magellan and his men.

5. I am the scholar who wrote De Moluccis Insulis in 1523.

Answers Key:

I. IDENTIFICATION

- | | |
|--|--|
| 1. Fr. Pablo Pastells | 6. Fr. Francisco Colin |
| 2. Francisco Albo | 7. Maximilian of |
| 3. Agusan River (or Agusan River Delta) | Transylvania |
| 4. Antonio Pigafetta | 8. King of Butuan (or Rajah Siau) |
| 5. Easter Sunday, March 31, 1521 | 9. Limasawa (or Mazaua) |
| | 10. Miguel López de Legazpi |

II. MULTIPLE CHOICE

1. **b (9 and 2/3 degrees North)**
2. **c (Publishing a massive 55-volume work with direct English translations of Pigafetta's account.)**
3. **b (Seven days)**
4. **a (Pigafetta never mentions navigating a massive river delta, which dominates Butuan's geography.)**
5. **c (Tadpole-shaped)**
6. **b (A brick monument in Magallanes, near Butuan)**
7. **a (Subuth / Cebu)**
8. **b (A wealthy, highly advanced pre-colonial hub for maritime trade.)**
9. **b (Fr. Francisco Combés)**



10. d (Trinidad)

III. MATCHING TYPE

- | | |
|-----------------|---------------------|
| 1. C. Seilani | 6. F. Fr. Pedro de |
| 2. H. Dumagsa | Valderrama |
| 3. D. Homonhon | 7. A. April 4, 1521 |
| 4. E. 1565 | 8. G. Subuth |
| 5. B. Balanghai | 9. J. Rajah Kolambu |
| | 10. I. Victoria |

IV. ENUMERATION

1. Antonio Pigafetta; Francisco Albo
2. Rajah Kolambu; Rajah Siaiu
3. Fr. Francisco Colin; Fr. Francisco Combés
4. Balanghai boats; Golden Tara
5. Homonhon; Cebu

V. FILL IN THE BLANKS

1. Easter
2. 9
3. tadpole
4. Miguel López de Legazpi
5. delta

VI. SEQUENCING

1. First Mass in Mazaua (1521)
2. Maximilian published *De Moluccis Insulis* (1523)
3. Legazpi expedition arrived (1565)
4. Butuan monument erected (1872)
5. Blair and Robertson published work (1903–1909)

VII. WHO AM I?

1. Antonio Pigafetta
2. Francisco Albo



3. **Fr. Pedro de Valderrama**

4. **Rajah Kolambu**

5. **Maximilian of Transylvania**

Reminder: "History is not merely a list of facts to be memorized, but an ongoing system of discovering the truth through the critical analysis of raw data."

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BAGONG PILIPINAS

HIST 111: READINGS IN PHILIPPINE HISTORY

CHAPTER 7: THE FIRST MASS SITE IN THE PHILIPPINES

Submitted by:

REPORTER

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BSIT 3-F3

Submitted to:

MA'AM HILDA PURA

Submitted on:

APRIL 27, 2026



Instructional Material (IM)

Subject: Readings in Philippine History

Topic: Primary Source Analysis – Limasawa vs. Butuan

I. Overview of the Lesson

This lesson examines one of the most debated historical issues in Philippine history—the exact location of the **First Catholic Mass in 1521**. For centuries, historians believed that the event took place in Butuan. However, modern historical analysis, supported by primary sources, has shifted the accepted location to Limasawa.

Through this lesson, students will explore how historical interpretations change over time due to new evidence, improved access to sources, and more critical methods of analysis. The focus will be on understanding how primary documents are used to reconstruct historical events and resolve controversies.

II. Learning Objectives

By the end of this lesson, students should be able to:

1. Clearly distinguish between the **Butuan Tradition** and the **Limasawa Evidence**.
 2. Identify and describe the importance of primary sources in historical research.
 3. Analyze the contents of **Albo's Log-book** and **Pigafetta's Testimony**.
 4. Trace the route taken by Magellan's expedition based on available records.
 5. Evaluate the reasons behind the shift in historical consensus.
 6. Develop critical thinking skills by examining conflicting historical interpretations.
-

III. Importance of Primary Sources in History

Primary sources are firsthand accounts created by individuals who directly experienced historical events. These include journals, logs, letters, and official records. In studying the First Mass controversy, primary sources are crucial because they provide direct evidence rather than interpretations made years later.

Without primary sources, historians rely on secondhand accounts, which may contain errors, biases, or misinterpretations. The rediscovery and analysis of original documents often lead to corrections in historical narratives.

IV. Key Historical Sources

The debate between Butuan and Limasawa is largely based on two important eyewitness accounts:

1. Francisco Albo's Log-book

- A navigational record written by Francisco Albo, a pilot aboard Magellan's ship *Trinidad*.
- Contains detailed coordinates, directions, and distances traveled.
- Considered reliable for geographical data due to its technical nature.



2. Antonio Pigafetta's Testimony

- A comprehensive journal written by the expedition's chronicler.
- Provides detailed descriptions of places, people, and events.
- Includes the name "Mazaua," which is central to identifying the location of the First Mass.

These two sources complement each other—Albo provides precise navigation details, while Pigafetta gives descriptive and narrative context.

V. The Comparative Evidence

A. The Butuan Tradition (17th – 19th Century)

For over 300 years, the dominant belief was that the First Mass occurred in Butuan.

Key Points:

- Supported by early Spanish historians such as Fr. Francisco Colin and Fr. Francisco Combes.
- Based mainly on secondary accounts rather than direct eyewitness records.
- Claimed that Magellan landed in Butuan, planted a cross, and celebrated Mass on Easter Sunday (March 31, 1521).
- This belief became widely accepted and institutionalized in Philippine history.

Historical Significance:

- A monument was erected in Butuan in 1872 to commemorate the event.
- The tradition was taught in schools and included in early historical writings.

Limitations:

- Lacked strong evidence from primary sources.
- Contained geographical inconsistencies when compared with navigational records.

B. The Limasawa Evidence (Modern Consensus)

Modern historians revisited the issue by analyzing primary documents more carefully.

Key Findings:

- Both Albo and Pigafetta placed the island at approximately **9 $\frac{2}{3}$ ° North latitude**.
- Pigafetta identified the island as **Mazaua**, now associated with Limasawa.
- The route described matches the geography of Southern Leyte, not Butuan.



Comparative Table:

Feature	Albo’s Log-book	Pigafetta’s Testimony
Latitude	9 $\frac{2}{3}$ ° North	9 $\frac{2}{3}$ ° North
Route	From Homonhon westward to Seilani (Leyte)	Guided to Mazaua (Limasawa) by its king
Geography	No high mountains south/southwest	Mentions two native rulers and a week-long stay

Conclusion:

The evidence strongly supports Limasawa as the correct site of the First Mass.

VI. Critical Thinking Activity: “The Route Check”

Scenario:

At Gatighan, the Spanish ships moved faster than the native boats led by the King of Mazaua. As a result, they had to slow down and wait.

Task:

Examine a map of the Philippines and trace the route passing through:

- Poro
- Pasihan
- Ponson (Camotes Islands)

Guide Questions:

1. Does the route logically originate from Butuan or Limasawa?
2. Which location better aligns with the described direction toward Cebu?
3. How does geography help verify historical claims?

Purpose:

This activity helps students apply geographical reasoning to historical analysis, reinforcing the importance of spatial evidence in verifying historical accounts.

VII. Reasons for the Shift in Historical Interpretation

The change from the Butuan claim to the Limasawa conclusion did not happen immediately. Several factors contributed to this shift:

1. Misinterpretation of Early Historians



- Early writers relied on incomplete or secondhand information.
- Confusion in geographical descriptions led to incorrect conclusions.

2. Limited Access to Original Documents

- Pigafetta's full manuscripts were not widely available for centuries.
- Many historians depended on summaries or translations that omitted key details.

3. Advances in Historical Research

- Scholars like Pablo Pastells and James Robertson re-examined original texts.
- Improved methods of analysis allowed for more accurate interpretations.

4. Use of Scientific and Geographic Evidence

- Coordinates and navigation routes were analyzed more precisely.
- Matching descriptions with actual locations led to more reliable conclusions.

VIII. Key Insight

This historical debate highlights an important idea:

History is not fixed—it evolves as new evidence emerges and existing evidence is reinterpreted.

Understanding this helps students appreciate that history is an active process of investigation rather than a static collection of facts.

IX. Assessment Questions

1. Why did the Butuan tradition remain widely accepted for more than 300 years?
2. What primary sources were used to challenge the Butuan claim?
3. According to Pigafetta, what was the name of the island where the First Mass was held?
4. What is the significance of the coordinate **9°40' N** in identifying the location?
5. How did the King of Mazaua assist Magellan's expedition?
6. Explain how geographical evidence supports the Limasawa claim.
7. What does this historical debate teach us about the nature of historical inquiry?

X. Enrichment Activity (Optional)

Students may:

- Create a **map illustration** tracing Magellan's route.
- Conduct a **mini-debate** defending either Butuan or Limasawa using evidence.
- Write a short reflection on why primary sources are important in understanding history.



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